EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 25 OCTOBER 2026

ZIP 93012, East Camarillo and Santa Rosa Valley

An El Niño winter here means atmospheric-river storms on Conejo and Calleguas creeks and a small debris-flow risk above The Springs. But a quarter of residents are 65 or over, so the likeliest deaths are among older people when the power fails or flu and RSV peak. The first moves are to reach the 355 people on powered medical equipment and to get vaccines into the senior communities now.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Ventura County, CA (inferred)	None published for the US, California, or the county	n/a here; global 6-month figure 239,000 ± 11,000	Creek flooding and low-water crossings; debris flow at The Springs; outages, smoke, and winter respiratory illness among older residents

13/13 recommendations checked. 2 confirmed outright, 8 corrected, 0 unverified, 3 contraindicated. The nine household steps were checked separately (3 confirmed, 6 corrected). The funding target fell 64% in verification, from $225,000 to $81,000, because the Mountain Fire scar turned out to lie entirely outside this ZIP and the local debris-flow

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



34.20°N 118.99°W, United States of America · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** In 1983, a very strong El Niño, Conejo Creek flooded Camarillo Springs; in December 2014, 1.8 inches of rain on a burn scar damaged 16 homes in The Springs. No storm death is on record in this ZIP.
- **For you.** Register with VC Alert today, fit a $20–40 CO alarm, and buy flood cover by 10 November (median $968 a year here).*
- **The money.** $41,000 floor, $81,000 target, $381,000 ceiling; the cheapest lives saved are batteries for medical-device users SCE's free programme does not cover.
- **Do not.** Do not rely on voluntary orders drawn along roads in a debris-flow zone: at Montecito in 2018, 19 of the 23 who died lived in the voluntary zone.*

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

hazard is a 13-year-old scar. Exposure: Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk*, September 2026, pre-peer-review. It publishes no figure for the United States, California, or Ventura County, and heat is not this place's winter hazard. No population-scaled figure is given here.

READ THIS FIRST

EL NIÑO AND THIS ZIP

El Niño raises the odds of a wet winter here; it does not promise one. NOAA's Climate Prediction Center has an El Niño Advisory in effect and expects a strong to very strong event through early 2027, and its 90-day outlook leans wet for much of California. But the very strong El Niño of 2015–16 left downtown Los Angeles with about 65% of its normal rain, and the January 2023 storms that brought a federal disaster declaration came in a La Niña winter. Every action below is triggered by an atmospheric-river or flood forecast, not by the El Niño label. If the winter starts dry, do not stand down.

ZIP 93012 has 35,791 people (ACS 2020–24), and 24.3% are 65 or over, against 17.4% county-wide. It contains east Camarillo, Leisure Village, Rancho Adolfo, The Springs at Camarillo Springs, Santa Rosa Valley, and CSU Channel Islands. It does *not* contain Somis (93066) or Camarillo Heights (93010), and the November 2024 Mountain Fire scar lies about 2 km north of the ZIP boundary. The fire scars inside 93012 are the Springs Fire (2013) and the Hill Fire (2018).

FOR YOU, AS A HOUSEHOLD

9 STEPS

For a household in 93012, an El Niño winter means more storms on Conejo and Calleguas creeks, flooded low crossings, and power cuts, coming straight after the Santa Ana fire and smoke season. No storm death is on record in this ZIP. The real risks are a car in floodwater, a debris flow at The Springs, and older people left without power, warmth, or medical care. The ranked actions below are written for the city, the county, and their partners. These nine are the ones you can take yourself, at your own cost, grouped by what they protect. Added at the request of El Niño Ready, following the format first used for Charleston, South Carolina.

1 · Floods and debris: if you live in The Springs, leave on a warning, not an order; and never drive into water at Adohr Lane, Ridge View Street, or Lewis Road

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTIONS 3 AND 5

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Now, all winter	$0	Everyone in the house and the car

Look up your evacuation zone by address at protect.genasys.com, which is the zone map Ventura County uses. In December 2014 most of The Springs was under only a voluntary order when about 1.8 inches of rain brought mud and boulders off the Springs Fire scar. Sixteen homes were damaged, and an elderly couple and their caretaker who stayed had to be rescued. So if you live on San Como Lane, Gitana Avenue, or Camarillo Springs Road, leave when a warning is issued, and do not stay behind to sandbag. Sandbags are free at Ventura County fire stations (call 805-371-1111 to confirm), but they protect property, not people. About 63% of US flood deaths happen in vehicles. In March 2023 there were a few feet of water on Adohr Lane and Ridge View Street, and the county plans to close Lewis Road when Calleguas Creek rises. If you cannot see the road surface, turn around.*

2 · Carbon monoxide: fit a CO alarm on each floor and outside the bedrooms, and run any generator outdoors, at least 20 feet from the house

CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 6

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 Nov 2026	$20–40 per alarm	Everyone asleep in the house

California Health and Safety Code §17926 already requires CO alarms in homes with gas appliances, a fireplace, or an attached garage; fit one in a mobile home too. Portable generators cause about 85 CO deaths a year in the US, mostly at homes (CPSC, 2022). Never run one in a garage or carport, and point the exhaust away from doors, windows, and vents. Test the alarm monthly.*

3 · Power: get SCE's outage and shutoff alerts, and if anyone at home uses an oxygen concentrator, CPAP, or other powered device, enrol in Medical Baseline now

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 1

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 Nov 2026	$0 to enrol; about $30–60 for power banks and lights (estimate)	Medical devices, phones, the fridge

Set outage and Public Safety Power Shutoff alerts in your SCE account (sce.com/psps). Medical Baseline is free and needs a medical practitioner's certification. SCE gives a free backup battery to customers who are on Medical Baseline, use a powered medical device,

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

and live in a high fire-risk area. In this ZIP that probably means The Springs and Santa Rosa Valley, not flat east Camarillo, so check your address. Anyone with a disability can also ask about a free portable battery from the Disability Disaster Access and Resources programme (CFILC). Federal data count 355 Medicare beneficiaries in 93012 who rely on electricity-dependent equipment.*

4 · Smoke and fire, before the rains: set up one clean-air room and keep N95 masks and a packed bag

CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 10

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Before the next Santa Ana event	$60–150 (box fan and MERV-13 filter); $100–300 (HEPA cleaner)	Lungs and hearts, especially over-65s

The Springs Fire (2013) and the Hill Fire (2018) both forced evacuations of Camarillo Springs and CSU Channel Islands, and the Mountain Fire burned just north of the ZIP in November 2024. Portable cleaners cut indoor fine particles by roughly half, though the evidence that this improves health is weak. If you build a box-fan filter, use a fan made in 2012 or later with a UL or ETL mark, do not leave it running unattended or while you sleep, and do not use an extension cord (EPA).

5 · Food: keep three days of food that needs no cooking and no fridge, and a $5–10 fridge thermometer

CONFIRMED ROLE-SPECIFIC

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
30 Nov 2026	About $50–75 a person for food; $5–10 per thermometer (estimates)	Your household's meals

Food reaches Camarillo by truck, and the shops kept working through past storms, so a few days' supply covers outages and closed roads; there is no need to stockpile. USDA's rule for outages: a closed fridge keeps food safe about 4 hours, a full freezer 48 hours, and a half-full one 24. Throw out perishables that have been above 40°F for more than 2 hours.

6 · Water: store a gallon per person per day for at least three days, and find out which water company serves your address

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED ROLE-SPECIFIC

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
30 Nov 2026	About $20–40 for containers (estimate)	Drinking water

Several water companies serve 93012; look up your address on the Water Service Providers map at camrosa.com/awsp. Camrosa Water District (805-482-4677) serves much of east Camarillo, Santa Rosa Valley, and CSU Channel Islands. The City of Camarillo's water division is on 805-388-5325, and California American Water on 1-888-237-1333; small mutual companies such as Pleasant Valley Mutual and Crestview Mutual also operate nearby. During the November 2024 Mountain Fire, Cal Am and two mutual companies issued *do-not-use* notices, not boil-water notices, because boiling does not remove fire-debris chemicals. Stored water covers you if that happens again. Notices go out by VC Alert and on vcemergency.com.*

7 · Communications: register with VC Alert, keep a weather radio, and name two neighbours you will check on

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 3

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Today, and by 15 Nov 2026	$0; about $25–40 for a radio	Warning time when phones and power fail

Register your home address, cell phone, and email with VC Alert at vcalert.org or on 888-772-4482. Alerts come in English and Spanish. In the Mountain Fire some nearby residents received no alert, and one 75-year-old learned of the order from a firefighter at her door. CSU Channel Islands students and staff get email alerts automatically; add phone and text in myCI under Alert Settings. NOAA Weather Radio for this area is most likely KIH34 (Broadcast Peak, 162.400 MHz); set the county code 006111. This was not confirmed against the NWS station list. Ventura County's smoke text alert is HUMO (Spanish, Mixteco, or Zapoteco) or SMOKE (English) to 855-522-0034; send a test, because we could not confirm it still runs. Pick two neighbours who live alone, especially older people on San Como Lane and Gitana Avenue, and check on them before and after storms. CERT Camarillo trains volunteers free; call (805) 383-5688.

8 · Health: flu and COVID shots now, the one-time RSV dose if you qualify, a week of prescriptions on hand, and an emergency plan with your dialysis clinic if you need one

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 2

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
As soon as possible; by 15 Nov 2026	$0 under Medicare Part B (flu, COVID) and Part D (RSV)	Lungs, hearts, kidneys

If you are 65 or over, ask for a high-dose, adjuvanted, or recombinant flu vaccine, and get the updated COVID vaccine. RSV vaccine is a single lifetime dose for everyone 75 and over, and for adults 50 to 74 with a chronic condition. California's public health department (CDPH, 17 September 2026) set this season's guidance after a federal court stayed the national advisory committee's votes. CDC's target was the end of October, so go now. Twenty-eight Medicare beneficiaries in this ZIP are on dialysis. If you are one of them, ask your clinic now for its emergency plan and the 3-day emergency diet.*

9 · Money: buy flood cover by 10 November, renters included, and sign up for bill discounts if you qualify

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 7

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Flood cover by 10 Nov 2026	Median $968/yr (zone X), $423/yr contents-only, in 93012	The house, its contents, and the bills

Every dollar the federal flood programme has ever paid in 93012, $630,542, went to homes *outside* the mapped flood zone, mostly after the 2014 debris flow at The Springs. A new policy takes 30 days to start, and the programme's authority runs only to 11 December 2026 under the current stopgap; if it lapses, no new policies can be sold. Renters can buy contents-only cover. In California a homeowners or renters policy may cover a debris flow caused by a recent wildfire (Department of Insurance, September 2026); check yours. SCE's CARE programme takes 32.5% off the bill and FERA 18%. For heating help (LIHEAP), apply at caliheapapply.com or through Community Action of Ventura County (message line 805-436-4021). Federal LIHEAP funding for 2027 is uncertain, so apply early.

What to ask of the people in charge

- Ask **City of Camarillo Public Works** when the three debris nets above The Springs were last emptied, and whether they will be cleared before the first storm (action 4).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- Ask the **Ventura County Sheriff's Office of Emergency Services** whether The Springs has a pre-written mandatory order and what rainfall forecast triggers it (action 3).
- Ask **SCE** whether your address is in a high fire-risk tier for the free Critical Care Backup Battery and the $150 power-station rebate (action 1).

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet. One rule underlies the ranking: no storm death is on record in this ZIP, but a quarter of its people are 65 or over, so the actions that protect older people through outages and the respiratory season come first.

1. Reach the 355 people on electricity-dependent medical equipment: Medical Baseline enrolment, a battery for each, and building rosters at Leisure Village and Rancho Adolfo

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MGR · ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST · SKEPTIC | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Ventura County Public Health (named emPOWER request); SCE (Medical Baseline, backup battery); the county's DDAR independent living partner	**Matching by 15 Nov; batteries by 15 Dec**	**SCE battery free where eligible; $26,000 for navigators and 20 power stations (see funding)**	**Deaths from failed oxygen, dialysis, and other devices during storm outages and shutoffs**

The HHS emPOWER service, re-queried on 25 October 2026, counts 10,517 Medicare beneficiaries in 93012, of whom 355 use electricity-dependent equipment, including 28 on dialysis, 26 on oxygen, and 11 in home hospice. The public file is de-identified, so the county must request the named file through the state, then match it against SCE's Medical Baseline list. SCE's free Critical Care Backup Battery requires Medical Baseline, a powered medical device, and a high fire-risk address; in this ZIP that probably covers The Springs and Santa Rosa Valley but not flat east Camarillo. The DDAR programme (CFILC) fills part of that gap with free portable batteries for people with disabilities. In the 2003 New York blackout, non-accidental deaths rose 25% (95% CI 12–41%) and accidental deaths 122% (Anderson & Bell, *Epidemiology* 2012). During California's 2019 shutoffs, emergency visits among people 65 and over rose by 15 per 100,000 on peak days (Harding et al., *Disaster Med Public Health Prep* 2026).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the 28, 26, and 11 are subsets of the 355, not additions. SCE's eligibility page does not mention frequent-shutoff circuits. Harding measured emergency visits, not deaths. No study measures how much enrolment itself reduces deaths; the evidence is for the harm, from New York and California outages.

2. Run on-site flu, COVID, and RSV clinics at Leisure Village, Rancho Adolfo, and The Springs in early November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Ventura County Public Health, or a contracted pharmacy; community management	Clinics booked for the first half of November	Vaccines $0 to residents under Medicare; clinic staff time	Respiratory deaths among the 8,682 residents aged 65 and over during the December–February peak

Leisure Village has 2,136 homes for people 55 and over, Rancho Adolfo is a 55-and-over manufactured-home park, and The Springs is a gated 55-and-over community of about 259 homes. High-dose flu vaccine gave 24.2% better protection than standard dose in people 65 and over (DiazGranados, *NEJM* 2014), though the larger DANFLU-2 trial missed its primary endpoint (*NEJM* 2025). RSV vaccine was about 83% effective against RSV lower-respiratory disease (Papi, *NEJM* 2023). This season's guidance in California comes from CDPH (17 September 2026): enhanced flu vaccine for 65 and over, COVID for everyone 65 and over, and one RSV dose for everyone 75 and over and at-risk adults 50–74.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: a federal court stayed the reconstituted ACIP's votes in March 2026, so CDPH and the West Coast Health Alliance, not ACIP, set COVID and RSV guidance this season. CDC's target was the end of October, so November is late but still before the peak. No 2026 county clinic at these communities was found; this is a proposal. The evidence is from older adults in high-income countries, which transfers well.

3. Pre-write a mandatory debris-flow order for The Springs (San Como Lane, Gitana Avenue), and back it with door knocks

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN · FRONTLINE · PHILANTHROPIST | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Ventura County Sheriff's Office of Emergency Services, with Ventura County Fire; The Springs HOA and CERT Camarillo for door knocks	Order written by 15 Nov; knocks on each flood watch	Staff time; $15,000 for door-to-door enrolment (see funding)	Residents staying home under a voluntary order when the hill comes down

On 12 December 2014, about 1.8 inches of rain sent mud and boulders off the 2013 Springs Fire scar into The Springs. Sixteen homes were damaged and 10 red-tagged; most residents were under only a voluntary order, and an elderly couple and their caretaker had to be rescued. No one died. In Montecito in January 2018, 19 of the 23 people who died lived south of Highway 192, in the voluntary zone. Write the order now, draw its zone from the gully mouths and runout, not the street grid, and issue it the evening before the forecast rain rate is reached. Many residents of The Springs live alone behind a gate, so the HOA and CERT should hold a list of who needs a knock.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the "0.5 inches an hour" trigger could not be traced to a current county rule; USGS thresholds use 15-minute rain intensity, so the order should cite the NWS/USGS threshold for this scar. The Springs scar is 13 years old and the Hill scar 8, so both are largely revegetated; the risk now is smaller than in 2014 but still real (see action 4). The Mountain Fire scar is outside 93012 and is not covered here. Whether a current Genasys debris-flow zone exists for The Springs was not verified.

4. Empty the three debris nets and the drainage inlets above The Springs before the first storm and after every storm, and walk the creek levees

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN · PHILANTHROPIST | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
City of Camarillo Public Works (nets and inlets); Ventura County Watershed Protection (Calleguas, Conejo, and Revolon levees)	15 Nov, then after each storm	Existing maintenance budgets	A full net or blocked drain sending mud into homes

The City owns ring-net barriers in three gullies above The Springs, with 24,000 cubic yards of capacity, installed by 31 January 2016 for about $2 million. Both of this ZIP's damaging debris flows came in 2014, a near-normal winter: in late October, mud reached 11 homes on San Como Lane and officials blamed a clogged drainage canal. A net that is already full, or a blocked inlet, defeats the barrier. Downstream, the Calleguas levees broke in 1980, the Revolon Slough levee failed at Las Posas Road in 1983, and Conejo Creek flooded the sanitation plant, the golf course, and homes in Camarillo Springs in 1983.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: no published maintenance schedule or inspection record for the nets was found, and who maintains them after installation is not established. The $2 million is a single press figure. The levee history is from the county's own hotspot pages.

5. Pre-stage barricades at the shallow Conejo Creek crossings (Adohr Lane, Ridge View Street, Pancho and Howard Roads), and keep the county's Lewis Road and Las Posas Road closure triggers

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · PUBLIC HEALTH | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
City of Camarillo (city streets); Ventura County Roads (Lewis, Las Posas); CHP and Caltrans (US-101)	15 Nov 2026	Under about $20,000 (estimate, unverified)	Drivers swept off flooded crossings, the commonest kind of flood death

About 63% of US flood deaths are vehicle-related (Ashley & Ashley 2008; CIRA 2025). During the Conejo Creek flood warning of 14–15 March 2023, a few feet of water stood on Adohr Lane and Ridge View Street. The county's hotspot plans already tell County Roads to prepare to close Lewis Road at 13,000 cfs on Calleguas Creek, and Lewis, Las Posas, and Hueneme roads at 21,000 cfs, which would cut off CSU Channel Islands. The gap is pre-staged barricades on the city side, tied to the Conejo Creek and Calleguas Creek (CLLC1) gauges.

Corrections: the Adohr Lane flooding was in March 2023, not during Hurricane Hilary; Hilary evacuated three homes on Trueno Court. No vehicle rescues on Pleasant Valley Road were found, so that claim is dropped. Jurisdiction over each crossing was inferred from location. These are national figures, not local ones.

6. Check CO alarms at Rancho Adolfo and in gas-heated homes, and push the generator message before the outage season

CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Ventura County Fire; CERT Camarillo; park and HOA management	Message out by 15 Nov	Low; alarms $20–40 each	CO deaths from generators and heaters run indoors during outages

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

CPSC (August 2022) attributes about 85 deaths a year to portable generators, 2017–2019, 81% of them at residential locations; it advises running generators at least 20 feet from the house with the exhaust pointed away. Most of the excess deaths after the 2003 New York blackout were CO poisonings. California's Health and Safety Code §17926 already requires alarms where there are gas appliances, fireplaces, or attached garages.*

Whether §17926 reaches mobile homes, which are regulated by the state housing department, is not confirmed; fit alarms there anyway. No effect size exists for alarm checks themselves.

7. Run a flood-cover drive to the zone-X streets by 10 November, before the 30-day wait and the 11 December lapse date

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MGR | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
City of Camarillo (mailer); households	Mailer out by 1 Nov; policies bought by 10 Nov	About $10,000 for a mailer (estimate); median premium $968	Uninsured ruin in a flood or debris flow; it saves money, not lives

OpenFEMA, re-queried for 93012, shows 426 policies in force ($127.1 million of cover), 299 of them in mapped A zones. Of 16 claims since 1997, all $630,542 paid went to homes in X, B, or C zones, and $593,108 came from the December 2014 debris flow. The A-zone claims all paid nothing. Across Ventura County only 1.64% of homes carry flood cover. The programme's authority runs to 11 December 2026 (P.L. 119-103); if it lapses, no new policies can be written.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: California homeowners and renters policies can cover debris flow caused by a recent wildfire (Department of Insurance alert, 23 September 2026), so "homeowners policies exclude mudflow" is not true for post-fire flows. The 30-day wait does not apply at a loan closing. Camarillo is not in the Community Rating System; joining at Class 9 would cut premiums 5%, but not before the peak. Ranked low because it protects finances, not lives.

8. Write the money triggers before the storm: a pre-drafted proclamation that switches on utility shutoff protections, and a VCCF pledge that pays evacuated households automatically

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sheriff OES (local proclamation and request to Cal OES); Ventura County Community Foundation (trigger pledge)	**Drafted by 1 Dec; issued at the first damaging storm**	**$0 for the proclamation; reserve up to $300,000 (see funding)**	**Households losing power for non-payment while recovering, and cash that arrives weeks late**

Under CPUC Decision D.19-07-015, a Governor's or President's emergency proclamation requires SCE and SoCalGas to suspend disconnections for non-payment and offer payment plans; a county-only emergency does not trigger it, and a Governor's proclamation needs a local proclamation first. Ventura County has done this before, for the early-2024 storms and the Mountain Fire. VCCF's Storm Fund opened *after* the December 2023 floods and paid about $400,000 to more than 300 families; no trigger-based pledge exists. Writing one now, released on an NWS flash-flood warning for The Springs or an evacuation order inside 93012, moves the money from the photograph to the forecast.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the 12-month duration of the protections could not be read in the decision text itself. The VCCF trigger pledge is new and would have to be negotiated.

9. Tell CalFresh households now that hours lost to storms can count as good cause under the new work rules

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Ventura County Human Services Agency	30 Nov 2026	Staff time	A wet month costing workers their wages and then their food benefits

The H.R.1 work rules for adults without dependants (ages 18–64, 80 hours a month) took effect in California on 1 June 2026, with no exemption for farm work. After the 2023 floods the UFW estimated that some Oxnard-area farmworkers lost up to two months of wages. Under 7 CFR 273.24(b)(2), a temporary absence for good cause, as the county determines it, counts as hours worked. The cut would arrive one or two months after the storm, when nobody is watching. The food signal itself is weak: USDA forecasts food-at-home prices up 2.3% in 2026 and 1.0% in 2027, and food reaches Camarillo by truck.

Corrections: the 2026 forecast is +2.3%, not +2.4%. Most farmworker housing, including Somis Ranch, is outside 93012, so this action mainly serves workers who live elsewhere and shop or work here.

10. Before the rains, get N95s to outdoor workers when the AQI reaches 151, and lend air cleaners to people on oxygen

CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · FRONTLINE | INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Employers (Santa Rosa Valley farms, landscapers, CSU Channel Islands grounds); Ventura County Air Pollution Control District	Now, through the Santa Ana season	Employer cost; $60–300 per cleaner	Smoke harm to outdoor workers and older residents

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Cal/OSHA §5141.1 requires employers to provide N95s at AQI 151–500 and makes respirators mandatory above 500. The Springs Fire (2013) and the Hill Fire (2018) both burned into this ZIP, and the Mountain Fire (November 2024) burned just to the north. Portable cleaners cut indoor fine particles by about 54–92%; evidence for health outcomes is weak.

Wearing an N95 is voluntary below AQI 500. This is a pre-rain hazard: the Santa Ana season usually runs into December.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	VC Public Health	Sheriff OES	VC Fire	City of Camarillo	VC Watershed / Roads	SCE	CERT & HOAs	VCCF	VC Human Services	Employers / APCD	Households
1. Medical-device users: enrolment, batteries, rosters	**A/R**	**C**				**R**	**R**	**C**			**R**
2. Flu, COVID, and RSV clinics on site	**A/R**						**R**				**R**
3. Mandatory debris-flow order and door knocks		**A/R**	**R**	**C**	**C**		**R**				**I**
4. Debris nets, inlets, and levees		**I**		**A/R**	**R**		**I**				
5. Barricades at flooded crossings		**C**		**A/R**	**R**						**I**
6. CO alarms; generators outdoors	**C**		**A/R**				**R**				**R**
7. Flood cover by 10 Nov				**A/R**			**C**				**R**
8. Proclamation and VCCF trigger pledge		**A/R**		**C**		**I**		**R**			
9. CalFresh good-cause guidance									**A/R**	**C**	**I**
10. N95s and air cleaners for smoke	**C**									**A/R**	**R**

What the chart shows: **County Public Health is accountable for the two highest-ranked rows**, so the health department, not the emergency office, carries most of the life-saving work here. **The City of Camarillo is accountable for three rows** (nets, crossings, and the flood-cover mailer), each paid from existing budgets. **CERT and the HOAs appear on five rows**, because the people most at risk live behind gates. Rows 3, 4, and 8 need a decision written down, not money.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs. No placement carries a measured cost per death averted; amounts are bottom-up unit costs, labelled as estimates.

FLOOR	TARGET	CEILING	LARGEST UNCERTAINTY
$41,000	$81,000	$381,000	Whether the storms come at all; 2015–16 was a very strong El Niño and a dry winter

Floor: device users $26,000 ($10,000 enrolment navigators + 20 power stations × $800, estimates) + door-to-door enrolment $15,000 (about 1,000 contacts × $15, estimates) = $41,000. **Target:** $41,000 + $40,000 held for 805UndocuFund (about 23 households × $1,750, its early

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Thomas Fire average) = $81,000. **Ceiling:** $81,000 + a VCCF reserve of up to $300,000 released on a trigger (120 evacuated households, the largest early count at The Springs in 2014, × $2,500, the housing grant VCCF paid after the Mountain Fire) = $381,000. **The target fell 64% in verification**, from $225,000: the 3,500-home outreach count could not be found, the Mountain Fire scar lies outside 93012, and a $25,000 Food Share placement was dropped because Food Share holds $40 million in net assets and can pre-position boxes from its own reserves.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Ventura County's DDAR independent living partner, with 211 Ventura County for referrals	Action 1: enrolment navigators, and 20 power stations for device users SCE's free battery does not cover	$26,000 (was $45,000)	Direct grant by 1 Nov	$10,000 + 20 × ~$800 (estimate, no rebate outside high fire-risk tiers); enrol in Medical Baseline first so ratepayer-funded batteries are not duplicated	Partially confirmed
CERT Camarillo (City of Camarillo), through VCCF	Action 3: door-to-door VC Alert enrolment and leave-on-a-warning plans at The Springs, Leisure Village, and the Santa Rosa Valley canyon edge	$15,000 (was $55,000)	Direct grant	~1,000 contacts × ~$15 (estimates); CERT training is already free; Mixteco only on MICOP's advice	Partially confirmed
805UndocuFund (MICOP, administered by VCCF)	Action 8: cash to storm-hit households excluded from FEMA individual aid	$40,000 held (was $100,000)	Cash transfer, on trigger	Thomas Fire and Montecito: ~$1.4M to 900+ families, early grants averaging $1,750; Mountain Fire: $78,000 to 178 households county-wide	Partially confirmed
Ventura County Community Foundation (FY2024 revenue $44.9M; $12.1M granted)	Action 8: reserve released on an NWS flash-flood warning for The Springs or an evacuation order in 93012	Up to $300,000 (was $750,000)	Pledge, released on trigger	120 households × $2,500; precedent $287,429 granted in about 3 weeks after the Mountain Fire, $975,313 by 10 weeks, county-wide	Partially confirmed

The funder's one thing: the cheapest lives saved here cost a funder nothing. Clearing the nets above The Springs is a Public Works duty (action 4), and SCE's batteries and the vaccines are already paid for by ratepayers and Medicare (actions 1 and 2). Philanthropy should pay for

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what those systems leave out: batteries for people outside the high fire-risk tiers, the knock on the door, and cash for households federal aid excludes. Do not fund the Mountain Fire scar from a 93012 budget; it is not in this ZIP.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives or waste the window here.

Draw debris-flow evacuation zones along roads, and rely on voluntary orders

CONTRAINDICATED

In Montecito on 9 January 2018, the line between mandatory and voluntary zones followed Highway 192, and 19 of the 23 people who died lived in the voluntary zone. Surveys afterwards found residents read "be prepared to leave" as "you are safe." In The Springs in December 2014, most residents were under a voluntary order, and people who stayed had to be rescued.

Instead: draw zones from the gully mouths and runout above The Springs, and issue a mandatory order the evening before the forecast rain rate (action 3).

Stay behind to sandbag a home in a debris-flow zone

CONTRAINDICATED

Sandbags divert shallow water; they do not stop a flow carrying mud and boulders. In December 2014 debris reached the eaves on San Como Lane, and an earthmover staged there in advance was buried. USGS's own assessment of the Springs Fire scar urges people to follow evacuation orders. No local death has been caused this way, so the verdict rests on the physics and the 2014 record, not on a local fatality.*

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Instead: sandbag only if you are outside the debris-flow zone, and leave The Springs when a warning is issued.

Have the City pay flat cash grants to households automatically when a rain gauge crosses a threshold

CONTRAINDICATED AS WRITTEN

Article XVI §6 of the California Constitution bars gifts of public funds. Disaster aid can survive under the public-purpose doctrine with council findings and need-based eligibility, but automatic, untargeted grants on a rainfall trigger are its weakest form. This is legal analysis, not a court ruling on this design; a neighbouring briefing for Ojai reached the same conclusion.

Instead: route household cash through VCCF or 805UndocuFund on need-based criteria (action 8), and seek a city-attorney opinion before committing City money.

Also avoid (lens advice, consistent with the verified record but not separately verified as actions): treating the El Niño declaration as the trigger, and standing down if the season starts dry; relying on phone alerts alone when shutoffs can last three to five days; and assuming the levees below US-101 will hold because they held last year.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
Mar 1978	Calleguas Creek peaks at 18,700 cfs (weak El Niño)	No deaths found	None recorded
Feb 1980	Calleguas Creek 25,300 cfs; several levee failures; Conejo Creek floods the golf course (borderline El Niño)	No deaths found	The county flood warning system
Mar 1983	Calleguas Creek 25,900 cfs; Revolon Slough levee fails at Las Posas Road; Conejo Creek (13,300 cfs) floods the sanitation plant, the golf course, and Camarillo Springs; Lewis Road badly damaged (very strong El Niño)	No deaths found	The county's hazard maps still use this flood
Feb 1998	Calleguas Creek 21,600 cfs; Highway 1 bridge flooded; Camarillo-Adohr gauge 35.16 in for the year, 282% of normal (very strong El Niño)	No deaths found	None recorded

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YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
Jan 2005	Calleguas Creek 19,700 cfs; levee erosion above CSU Channel Islands (weak El Niño)	No deaths found	None recorded
May 2013	Springs Fire, 24,251 acres; CSU Channel Islands evacuated; 15 homes damaged (neutral)	0	Left the burn scar above The Springs
Oct and Dec 2014	Debris flows into The Springs: a clogged drainage canal in late October, then 1.8 in of rain on 12 December; 16 homes damaged, 10 red-tagged (weak warm conditions)	0; a couple and their caretaker rescued	About $2M of ring-net barriers in three gullies, finished by 31 Jan 2016
2015–16	A very strong El Niño; downtown Los Angeles gets about 65% of normal rain	—	—
Nov 2018	Hill Fire, about 4,500 acres; Camarillo Springs and CSU Channel Islands evacuated (weak El Niño)	0	None recorded
Jan and Mar 2023	Atmospheric rivers (La Niña); federal disaster DR-4683; Conejo Creek flood warning on 14–15 March floods Adohr Lane and Ridge View Street	None in 93012	FEMA approved $8,893 for 15 homeowner registrations in 93012
Aug 2023	Tropical Storm Hilary; three homes on Trueno Court evacuated	0	—
Nov 2024	Mountain Fire, 19,904 acres, just north of the ZIP (Somis, Camarillo Heights); 243 structures destroyed, 127 damaged; do-not-use water notices from Cal Am and two mutual water companies (neutral)	0 deaths; 6 injured	Burn-scar warning, 13–14 Feb 2025; the outcome of that storm was not found

The recurrence nobody has noticed: the hazard here is fire first, then the next wet winter, and the damage has come from maintenance as much as rain. The Springs flooded from Conejo Creek in 1983, burned in 2013, and was hit twice by debris in 2014, a near-normal winter, once because a drain was blocked. The creek levees failed in the same stretch in 1980 and 1983 and eroded again in 2005, and the county's own report lists no physical upgrade after any of them. And in more than forty years of floods here, no storm death has been recorded in this ZIP. The people most likely to die this winter are older residents, during the outages and the respiratory season, which is why the health actions rank first.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **The debris flow at The Springs is the main threat** (emergency manager, historian, skeptic, frontline) versus **the deaths will be among older people in outages and the flu and RSV season** (public health). The report ranks health first: the 2014 flow killed no one, the scar is 13 years old, and 24.3% of residents are 65 or over. The debris-flow actions stay high because they cost little.
- **How old the Mountain Fire scar is** (historian: second winter; philanthropist: third). Both are moot here: a spatial check found the scar entirely outside 93012.
- **Spend before the storm** versus **hold most money on a trigger** (philanthropist). Both survive: device power and door knocks now, cash on a written trigger.
- **Mixteco-language outreach** (frontline, skeptic) versus **where Mixteco speakers live** (funding verifier). The county's Mixteco-speaking farmworkers mostly live in Oxnard and Somis, outside 93012, so the report funds English and Spanish outreach and adds Mixteco only on MICOP's advice.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

Care homes and assisted-living facilities in 93012 were not looked at, yet their residents are exactly the group the health actions target. **The Camarillo sanitation plant** on Conejo Creek flooded in 1983, and nobody checked whether it is protected now. **CSU Channel Islands' isolation** is a real risk: closing Lewis Road at 21,000 cfs would cut off the campus, and no lens examined campus sheltering. **Earthquake** is outside the El Niño brief but is this area's largest single risk; one parametric earthquake product (Jumpstart) may no longer be on sale after its acquisition.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people. They are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; floods, debris flows, outages, smoke, and respiratory illness are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

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- **Scope.** The request named ZIP 93012. It is treated as ZCTA 93012 (35,791 people, ACS 2020–24): east Camarillo, Leisure Village, Rancho Adolfo, The Springs at Camarillo Springs, Santa Rosa Valley, and CSU Channel Islands. Places were checked against the Census 2020 ZCTA layer: Somis (93066) and Camarillo Heights (93010) are outside it, and a spatial intersect of the CAL FIRE perimeter found the Mountain Fire does not enter it. Climate Impact Lab impact region, as this report records it: Ventura County, CA, inferred rather than resolved on the Impact Map. Mortality figures exist only at that scale (impact regions average roughly 300,000 people); sub-city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Heat is not this place's winter hazard, so the historical record carries the hazard instead.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief. A neighbouring briefing for Ojai (8 October 2026) was used as an evidence pack for Ventura County, and its claims were re-checked rather than inherited.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias: five lenses converged on burn-scar evacuation, and verification found the scar most of them pictured, the Mountain Fire, lies outside the ZIP, so the action was re-aimed at The Springs and ranked below the health actions. Contradictions were kept. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, given payers or marked unfunded, and reconciled against the funding placements.
- **Verification.** Six separate verifier agents checked the 10 actions, 3 contraindicated items, 9 household steps, the historical record, and the funding placements, on evidence, transferability, and feasibility. Financial actions were also checked for availability, a named payer, a trigger, and whether they already exist. Verifiers queried HHS emPOWER, OpenFEMA (NFIP policies v3, claims, penetration rates, and the Community Status Book), the Census geocoder and ACS, and the CAL FIRE perimeter layer directly, and read IRS filings on ProPublica. The envelope was re-summed.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not consulted for this location. The inventory renders no entries without a browser session, and its download was not reached in this run. No action here is marked as having or lacking a precedent there.
- **Reader.** The requester gave no role. The household section was added at El Niño Ready's request, in the expanded nine-step format first used for ZIP 29492 in Charleston. The steps are taken from the verified actions, and from household guidance for 93012 checked separately on the same three tests (3 confirmed, 6 corrected). The rest of the report is written for the city, the county, and their partners.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (evacuation, CO alarms, generators, medical equipment in an outage, drinking water, vaccines, and debris flows) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. The impact region was not resolved on the Impact Map. The CPUC decision PDF did not parse, so the 12-month duration of shutoff protections rests on utility filings. The NOAA Weather Radio station and the HUMO smoke-alert line could not be confirmed from primary sources. No current USGS debris-flow assessment exists for the Springs or Hill scars, and the outcome of the February 2025 Mountain Fire storm was not found. ENSO phases are from NOAA's ONI table.

References · HHS emPOWER REST service (queried 25 Oct 2026) · Census Reporter, ZCTA 93012 (verified) · Census TIGERweb ZCTA layer (queried) · SCE Critical Care Backup Battery (verified) · SCE backup power rebates (corrected) · Anderson & Bell 2012 (verified) · Harding et al. 2026 (verified) · CDPH 2026–27 respiratory guidance (verified) · Immunize.org, flu recommendations (verified) · ACIP stay, March 2026 (verified) · AAFP adult respiratory vaccines (verified) · Camarillo Springs debris flow, Dec 2014 (verified) · San Como Lane, clogged drain, 2014 (verified) · Camarillo Springs damage count (verified) · USGS Springs Fire debris-flow assessment (verified) · Geobrugg, Camarillo Springs barriers (verified) · Montecito evacuation zones (verified) · Montecito warning survey (lens) · VCWPD hotspot 380, Calleguas Creek (verified) · VCWPD hotspot 375, Conejo Creek (verified) · CNRFC, Calleguas Creek peaks (verified) · VCWPD rain gauge 194, ENSO years (corrected) · Conejo Creek flooding, Mar 2023 (verified) · FEMA DR-4683 (verified) · NPS, Springs Fire (verified) · Hill Fire, 2018 (verified) · CAL FIRE, Mountain Fire (verified) · Mountain Fire water notices (verified) · CPSC generator CO report, 2022 (verified) · Cal. H&S Code §17926 (verified) · Cal/OSHA §5141.1 (verified) · EPA, DIY air cleaners (verified) · OpenFEMA NFIP policies v3 (queried) · OpenFEMA NFIP claims (queried) · NFIP penetration, Ventura County (queried) · CRS, NFIP authorization (verified) · CDI alert on debris-flow cover, Sep 2026 (verified) · Utility emergency-protection filing (verified) · SCE CARE and FERA (verified) · LIHEAP FY2026–27 funding (verified) · LAO, H.R.1 CalFresh changes (verified) · 7 CFR 273.24 (verified) · USDA ERS food price outlook (verified) · Farmworker wage losses, 2023 (lens) · VCCF Mountain Fire update (verified) · VCCF Storm Fund, 2024 (verified) ·

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805UndocuFund payouts (verified) · Food Share, IRS filings (verified) · VC Alert (verified) · CSUCI Alert (verified) · HUMO smoke alerts, 2022 (not confirmed current) · Camrosa, water service providers (verified) · VCFD CERT coordinators (verified) · VCFD sandbag stations (2024 list) · USDA FSIS, outages (verified) · Ready.gov, water (verified) · NOAA ONI table (queried)

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 25 October 2026 for ZIP 93012, East Camarillo and Santa Rosa Valley. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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